



Duke University
Biological Sciences Building
130 Science Drive Box 90383
Durham, NC 27708-9976

27 May 2026

Jordan Lucore
420 West Hall
1085 S. University Ave
Ann Arbor, MI 48109

Dear Dr. Lucore:

I am pleased to offer you the position of Postdoctoral Associate within the Department of Evolutionary Anthropology. While this letter does not constitute an employment contract, it covers key employment provisions and is intended to provide you with a clear understanding of your compensation, benefits, and initial employment details.

Position Offered: Postdoctoral Associate
Direct Supervisor: Melissa Emery Thompson
Salary Offered: \$72,000
Appointment Start Date: July 1, 2026
Funding Source: 4518928

You will be involved in the department's research activities as follows: This position is in support of research integrating physiological biomarkers with demographic and behavioural data from a longitudinal study of aging and health in wild chimpanzees. Your duties will include oversight of wet laboratory activities, including running assays, upkeep of supplies, equipment, and safety protocols, quality control, and data management, as well as quantitative analysis across multiple sources of data. The postdoc is expected to lead research publications and collaborate with the PIs and other lab members to develop empirical data and research aims. This is a full-time research position.

You will be based in an office/lab located: French Family Science Center

This is a temporary one-year appointment anticipated to continue through 30 June 2027. This position may be renewed beyond the first-year contingent upon the availability of additional research funds and your first year's performance. You will be eligible for reappointment every July 1. You may also be eligible for annual increases beginning July 1 of each year based upon funding, your evaluation, and university compensation guidelines. Renewal of this postdoctoral appointment may not exceed five years except under limited extraordinary circumstances.

You will receive an annual performance evaluation based upon the [Individual Development Plan](#), or IDP, which will help identify your long-term career goals. You are strongly encouraged to begin your IDP so that we can discuss your goals in your initial meetings with me. I will assist you in your career development and mentor you during this next important step in your career.

- This appointment is contingent upon you meeting all requirements for the position. In addition, this offer is contingent upon successful completion of Duke University's standard background check.

- You will be an exempt, salaried staff member, meaning in part that you are exempt from overtime pay. There will be a 90-day [orientation and evaluation period](#) during which your performance will be evaluated. For new hires, during this 90-day period your paid time off (except for holidays) will not be available to you. Transfer employees may use accrued time with manager approval.
- Information regarding Duke's benefits and employment policies may be accessed through [Duke Human Resources](#). You will be required to attend a [New Staff Orientation Session](#) for Duke University and you may sign up for benefits at that time. We will notify you of this date. Details of your eligibility for benefits, such as insurance, retirement, and vacation/sick leave, may also be found at the [Office of Postdoctoral Services](#) under [Policies](#). Please contact your departmental HR/Business Manager, PI, or [Molly Starback](#), Director of the Duke Office of Postdoctoral Services, if you have questions about postdoctoral benefits.

IMPORTANT POINTS REGARDING BENEFITS ELIGIBILITY FOR POSTDOCTORAL ASSOCIATES:

- Postdoctoral Associates must [enroll for benefits](#) within the **first 30 days of employment**.
- Note that you may choose for your health insurance coverage to be effective on your first day of employment/eligibility, but if you choose this option, you will be responsible for the **total pre-tax premium for that month** (Duke's contribution plus the employee portion of the premium). You may also choose for your coverage to be effective on the first day of the month following your first day of employment/eligibility. If you choose this option, you will be responsible only for the employee portion of the premium.
- Postdoctoral Associates are eligible to participate in the [Duke Faculty and Staff Retirement Plan](#). Duke will make a contribution in the amount of 4% of salary to Postdoctoral Associates after they have completed one year of service at Duke and have attained age 21. The Duke contribution will be immediately vested. For more information: <https://hr.duke.edu/benefits/retirement/about-dukes-plans/faculty-staff-exempt/dukes-contribution-house-staff>
- Please note that **if you are awarded an external fellowship or are appointed to a NIH F32/T32 training grant or similar, your employment and benefits status may change**. For an outline of these changes, view the [Postdoctoral Policy and FAQ](#) at the [Office of Postdoctoral Services](#).
- As a term-limited position that will end on 30 June 2027, please understand that this position is not eligible for Duke severance benefits or the Duke Reduction in Force (RIF) policy. More information on the RIF policy may be found at <https://hr.duke.edu/policies/expectations/reduction-force#rights>.
- If your position is eliminated, a minimum of 90-day notification will be provided to you and the Department will work to support your search for employment elsewhere.

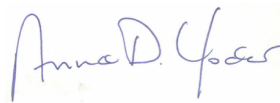
Your signature on this letter is an acknowledgement of your acceptance of this employment offer and the terms explained. Please return the original to me and Katherine Trinajstich and maintain a copy for your own records.

We look forward to having you as part of our team.

Sincerely,



Melissa Emery Thompson
Principal Investigator/Faculty Sponsor



Anne Yoder, PhD, Professor and Chair
Department of Evolutionary Anthropology

I accept the terms of this appointment as outlined above.

Jordan M. Lucore

Date

Cc: Office of Postdoctoral Services

Duke is an Equal Opportunity Employer committed to providing employment opportunity without regard to an individual's age, color, disability, gender, gender expression, gender identity, genetic information, national origin, race, religion, (including pregnancy and pregnancy related conditions), sexual orientation, or military status. Duke aspires to create a community built on collaboration, innovation, creativity, and belonging. Our collective success depends on the robust exchange of ideas—an exchange that is best when the rich diversity of our perspectives, backgrounds, and experiences flourishes. To achieve this exchange, it is essential that all members of the community feel secure and welcome, that the contributions of all individuals are respected, and that all voices are heard. All members of our community have a responsibility to uphold these values.